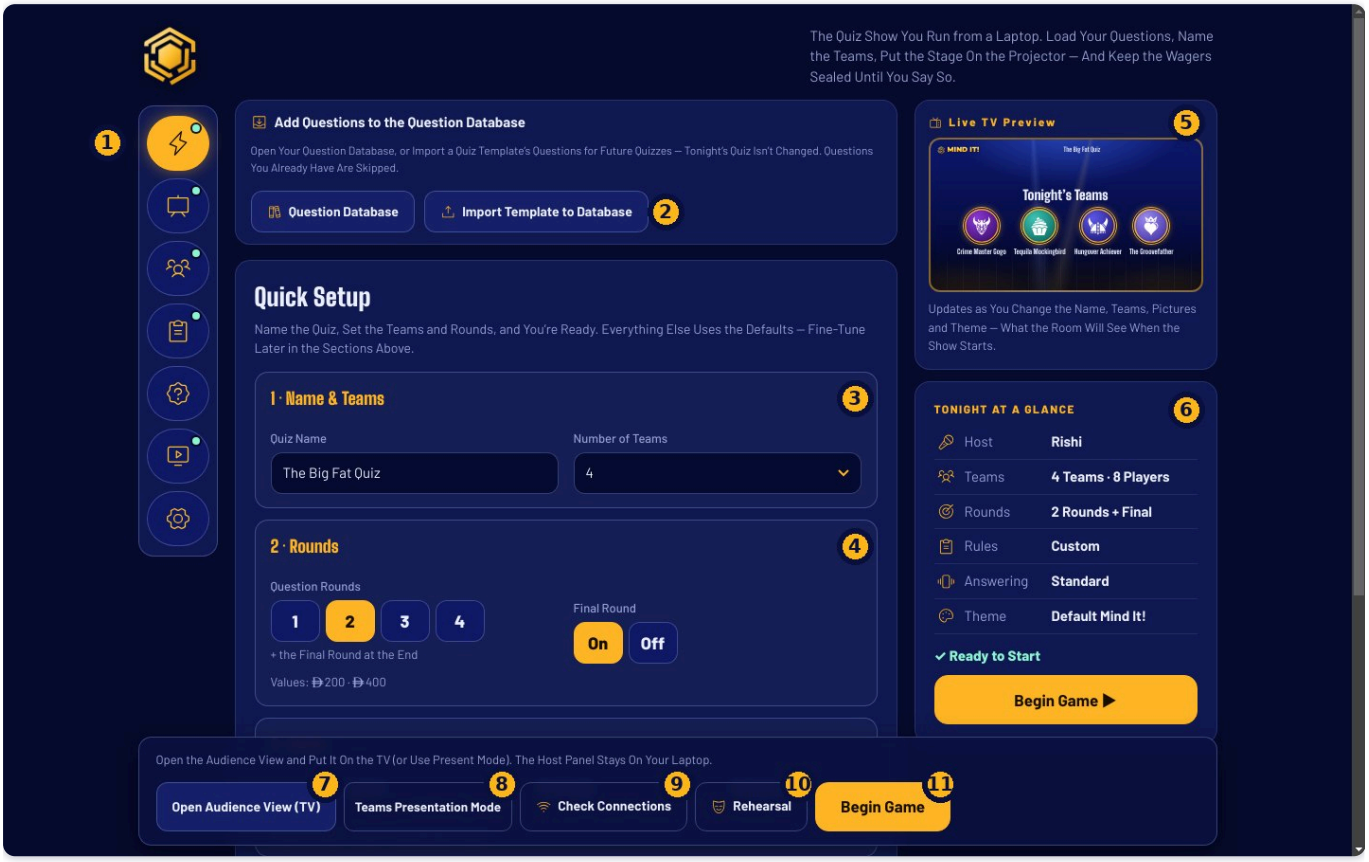
MIND IT! — QUICK START

Your first quiz in 10 minutes (Mind It! v1.69)

This is the short version. Everything here is explained in full — with real screenshots — in *The Complete Idiot's Guide* (`MIND_IT_COMPLETE_IDIOTS_GUIDE.pdf`).

1. Get the app running (2 minutes)

1. **Windows laptop:** put `Mind It!.exe.part1` , `.part2` , `.part3` and `Join Mind It - build 134.bat` in one folder. Double-click the **.bat**. When it says **Done**, double-click `Mind It!.exe` . (From the GitHub download page you get **one complete** `Mind It!.exe` — no joining.) - "Windows protected your PC"? → **More info → Run anyway**. - Windows asks about network access? → allow **Private networks** (phones and the tablet need it). - **Apple Silicon Mac instead?** Join the parts in Terminal and drag `Mind It!.app` into Applications (Complete Guide 4.1b). First open: **Apple menu → System Settings → Privacy & Security → Open Anyway**; allow **local network** access.
2. **Tablet (optional):** install `Mind It! for Android (Galaxy Tab).apk` (allow "install unknown apps"). **iPad or iPhone instead?** No install: on the laptop open 📲 **Connect ▾ → Connect Device** and scan the **iPad / iPhone** code with the Camera (Complete Guide, Setup B2). The first time it asks for the PIN; after that it reconnects by itself. Only one remote controls the quiz — a second one waits until you tap **Allow & Switch** on the laptop (Setup B4). **No laptop?** The tablet is then the server: team phones join the tablet (Setup B3).
3. Mind It! opens on **Setup** — the laptop's main menu.



2. Make the quiz (3 minutes)

On ⚡ **Quick Setup**:

1. **Quiz Name:** `The Big Fat Quiz`.
2. **Number of Teams:** 4 (2–8 allowed — at least 2).
3. **Question Rounds:** 2, **Final Round: On**. Values are automatic: Round 1 = 200–1,000, Round 2 = 400–2,000.
4. **Rules: Full Show** (everything on) — or **Family Night** for a gentle game, **Classic** for a pure quiz.
5. **Questions:** a new game is filled from your Question Database automatically. To load your own: **4 · Rounds & Questions → Download Starter Template (.xlsx)**, fill in the yellow cells, then drop the file on **Upload Your Question Template**.
6. **Teams: 2 · Teams & Players** → rename each team (✎) and add at least **one player** to each (**+ Player**). Or 🎲 **Random Teams**. A team with just one player automatically takes that player's name and picture.
7. **Quizmaster:** 2 · Teams & Players → 🎤 **Quizmaster → Host**. The Quizmaster can't play.

When **Tonight at a Glance** says ✔ **Ready to Start**, you're ready.

3. Connect the screens (3 minutes)

1. **TV:** plug in HDMI (Windows key + P → *Extend*). Press **Open Audience View (TV)**, drag the window to the TV, press its **Full Screen** button. **No cable?** (since build 130) 📺 **Audience View ▾ →** 📡 **Connect Audience Screen**, type the address it shows (e.g. `192.168.1.20/tv`) into the TV's web browser, press ⛶ **Full Screen** on the TV, then 🧪 **Test Audience Screen**. Want the sound from the TV's speakers? 🔊 **Sound On This TV**, then press **OK** on the TV remote (Complete Guide, Setup C2).
2. **Tablet:** laptop **Connect ▾ → Connect Device**; tablet **Connect To Laptop → Connect** (or scan the code / type the PIN).
3. **Phones:** the TV shows a **"Scan to Join Your Team"** QR code before the game. Each team scans it and types its **4-letter team code** (see 🔐 **Team Codes**). The phone says **Eyes On the TV**. iPhone tip: Safari **Share → Add to Home Screen** gives a full-screen **Mind It!** icon for next time (Complete Guide 8.6). - The same code is in 📲 **Connect ▾ →** 📶 **Devices → Phone Join QR (for Teams)** and **6 · Advanced → 5 · Phones & Live Wagers**. Don't want it on the TV? Switch it off in **5 · Audio & Presentation**.
4. **Everyone on the same Wi-Fi.** Guest/hotel Wi-Fi blocking phones? Turn on the **laptop's mobile hotspot** and join everything to it. No internet needed.
5. Press 📶 **Check Connections → TEST ALL CONNECTIONS**. Aim for "All set".

4. Play! (the rest of the night)

Press **Begin Game ▶**.

You want to…	Laptop	Tablet
Open a question	Click the value on the board preview	Tap the value
They're right	**Correct** (C) — shows ⚡ +100 while the speed bonus is on offer	✓ Correct
They're wrong (–points, next team tries)	**Wrong Answer** (W)	× Wrong Answer
They pass (free, next team tries)	**Pass** (S)	→ Pass
More time	**+30 Sec**	+30 Sec
Show the answer	**Reveal Answer** (R)	Reveal Answer
Next question	**Next Question** (N) — or wait 3½ s	Next Question
Oops!	**Undo** (U) — also gives back a chip	↶ Undo
Fix a score	More Controls → **Adjust Score**	± Adjust Score
Finish the round now	More Controls → **End Round Early** (E)	End Round Early

Scoring in one breath: right = **+value**; wrong = **–value** (the question goes to the next team with a fresh 45 s); pass = **0** (next team gets 30 s + time left, max 45 s). Answering a passed question = **+25% per pass**. The picking team answering right within **10 s** = **+half the round's lowest value** (Round 1: +100). **Daily Double:** bet from the value up to your score (or up to 1,000 if your score is lower). **Triple Gamble:** 3× (6× on a Daily Double). **Phoenix:** the last team, if more than 2,000 behind from Round 2, can score double + 20% of the gap (capped at the leader; only a speed bonus can take it past); wrong costs nothing. **Bottoms Up (Round 1):** wrong costs nothing if the designated player finishes their drink.

Final Round: teams with 0 or more points bet 0–their score on their phones, the question appears, they type one answer (typed answers close 2 s after time's up), you mark each one and press **Reveal** (lowest score first). Right = +bet, wrong = –bet. The Final question is locked once the Final starts. **Level on points at the end?** The team with more correct answers wins.

5. Finish

1. The final standings save the game to **Historic Games** automatically.
2. Show 🏅 **Achievements & Fun Stats** on the TV.
3. Tablet: 🏁 **END GAME** → "THANKS FOR PLAYING!" on the tablet and the phones (or **Back to Setup** on the laptop).
4. **⋯ ▾ → Backups & Restore → Back Up Now** — keep a copy.

If something goes wrong

- **The app closed?** Reopen it → **Resume saved game**. Re-open the Audience View. Phones and the tablet reconnect by themselves.
- **A phone won't join?** Same Wi-Fi, mobile data off, scan the TV code again — or use the laptop's hotspot.
- **Wrong score? Undo** (U) right away, or **Adjust Score** with a reason.
- **TV says "Reconnecting to Host..."?** Make sure the laptop's host window is open; it clears by itself.
- **Started the quiz on the Galaxy Tab and the laptop arrives?** Open Mind It! on the laptop (same Wi-Fi) → 💻 **Take Over Tablet Quiz** → approve it on the tablet. Scores, phones, remotes and TVs move across (Complete Guide, Setup B5). **The laptop has to leave?** 📲 **Connect ▾ → Hand Quiz to the Galaxy Tab → Offer Quiz**, then **Host It on This Tablet** on the tablet (Setup B6).
- **Something went wrong in the rehearsal?** 📲 **Connect ▾ →** 📋 **Rehearsal Report → Save Report File**, and send the file (Setup C3).
- **Before the guests arrive:** 📲 Connect ▾ → Connect Device → 🧪 **Test Hosting → Run Test** should say *Ready to host*.

Mind It! v1.69 · Quick Start · updated for build 134.